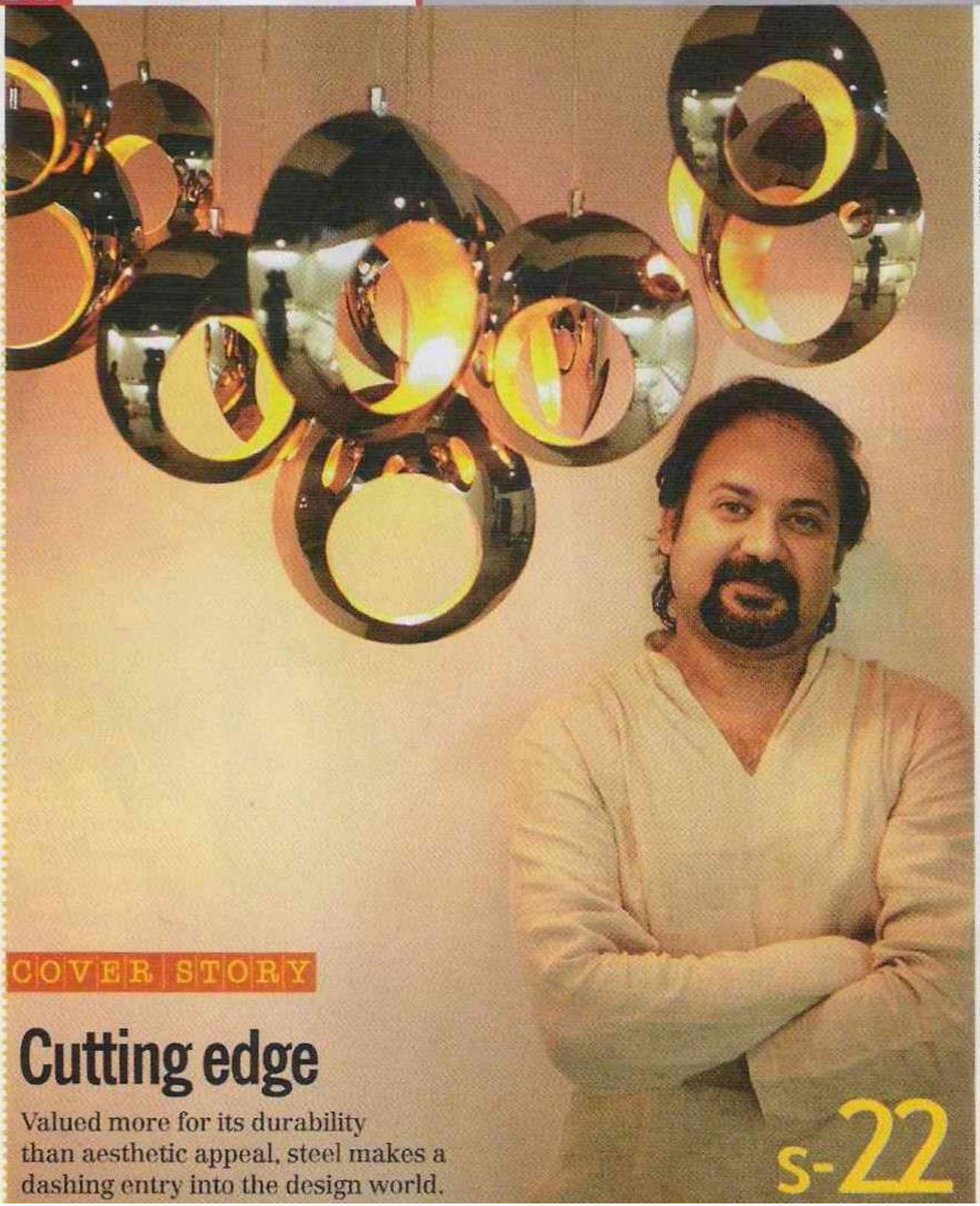
contents



VIKRAM SHARMA

COVER STORY

Cutting edge

Valued more for its durability than aesthetic appeal, steel makes a dashing entry into the design world.

S-22

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cover story

Photograph by VIKRAM VARMA

"The chandeliers have a mirror finish and the insides are gold-plated. One can create dramatic effects with mood lighting; it then becomes art."

vibhor sogani

"Steel motivates and inspires me to think out-of-the-box. It can be given various finishes, and its reflective property attracts me," says Vibhor Sogani. Huge curved steel leaves and mushroom-shaped installations welcome you at his Aaya Nagar studio, ODD (Office of Design & Development). The space is also littered with artworks; while some stand out for their varied satin smooth and matte finishes, others have been made as a combination of steel with other materials such as stone and wood.

The 40-year-old, an NID (National Institute of Design) graduate, has long worked in product, exhibition, interior and graphic design and has an established design studio with a team of architects, interior designers and accessory designers. Sogani's tryst with steel started when he was designing tableware. He later diversified into melding art and functionality into contemporary, stylish art pieces. While his installations are usually meant for corporate offices and landscaping, his chandeliers are his pride and joy. "The chandeliers have a mirror finish and the insides are gold-plated. Besides using it as normal lighting equipment, one can create dramatic effects with mood lighting; it is then that it becomes art," he says.

Sogani is currently planning a 40-foot chandelier (similar to the one in the picture) that will have 79 globes suspended from a high atrium. Also on the anvil are steel installations that will come up this September in the six acres of green between the flyovers at the AIIMS crossing.